

curiosity

noun

Word family: **curiosity** **curiosities**

- **What it means**

A strong desire to know or learn about something.

In kid words: When you really want to find out about something!

- **Teacher models (I Do)**

"Her curiosity about space led her to study the planets every night."

filled with curiosity **natural curiosity** **curiosity about the world**

- ✓ **Means the SAME**

interest **wonder** **eagerness**

- ✗ **Means the OPPOSITE**

indifference **boredom** **apathy**

- ✗ **NOT examples**

not caring about anything **ignoring something new** **refusing to explore**



Why we use it

Curiosity is what drives people to learn, explore, and discover new things in science and life!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The student showed _____ because...

happiness

noun

Word family: happy happier happily happiness unhappy
unhappiness

● What it means

The state of feeling pleased, content, or joyful.

In kid words: The good feeling you get when something makes you smile!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The students felt happiness when they finished their science project together."

pure happiness great happiness filled with happiness

✓ Means the SAME

joy delight cheerfulness

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

sadness misery sorrow

✗ NOT examples

feeling angry being very worried crying from pain



Why we use it

Happiness is an abstract noun that names a feeling you cannot touch but everyone can understand!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ brought happiness because...

fierceness

noun

● What it means

The quality of being intense, powerful, or aggressive.

In kid words: Being very strong and scary, like a wild animal!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The fierceness of the thunderstorm frightened the younger students."

fierceness in battle

showed fierceness

the fierceness of the storm

✓ Means the SAME

intensity

ferocity

wildness

× Means the OPPOSITE

gentleness

calmness

mildness

× NOT examples

*a quiet whisper**a soft kitten purring**a gentle breeze*

Why we use it

Fierceness is an abstract noun made from the adjective fierce. Understanding how to build abstract nouns from adjectives is a powerful vocabulary skill!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The animal showed _____ when...

training

verb

Word family: train trains training trained trainer retrain

● What it means

Preparing or learning skills through practice and instruction.

In kid words: Practicing something again and again so you get better at it!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The soccer team has been training for the big tournament for three months."

training for a race

training hard

training every day

✓ Means the SAME

practicing

preparing

exercising

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

resting

neglecting

ignoring

✗ NOT examples

watching television all day

sleeping through class

giving up after one try



Why we use it

Training is a progressive verb form (verb + -ing) that shows an ongoing action. It is used with helping verbs like is, are, was, and were!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The athlete was _____ because...

experiment

noun

Word family: experiment experiments experimental

experimentally experimented

● What it means

A scientific procedure carried out to test a hypothesis or discover something new.

In kid words: A test you do in science to find out if something is true!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Our class designed an experiment to test which type of soil helps plants grow fastest."

conduct an experiment a science experiment

the results of the experiment

✓ Means the SAME

test trial investigation

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

guess assumption theory

✗ NOT examples

reading a textbook without testing ideas just guessing without proof

copying answers

? Why we use it

Experiment is a key academic word used in science, and it can be both a noun (an experiment) and a verb (to experiment)!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ experiment showed that...

amazing

adjective

Word family: amaze amazes amazing amazed amazement
amazingly

● What it means

Causing great surprise or wonder; remarkably impressive.

In kid words: Something so cool or good that it makes you say wow!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The students built an amazing robot that could sort recycling automatically."

an amazing discovery truly amazing amazing technology

✓ Means the SAME

incredible wonderful

astounding

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

ordinary boring unremarkable

✗ NOT examples

a plain white wall a regular pencil something you see every day



Why we use it

Amazing is a powerful adjective that comes from the verb amaze. Using strong adjectives makes your writing more interesting and descriptive!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ was amazing because...

laboratory

noun

Word family: laboratory laboratories lab labs**● What it means**

A room or building equipped for scientific experiments, research, or testing.

In kid words: A special room where scientists do experiments and test ideas!**● Teacher models (I Do)**

"The students visited the university laboratory to watch a chemistry demonstration."

a science laboratory **working in the laboratory** **a chemistry laboratory****✓ Means the SAME****lab** **workshop** **research center****× Means the OPPOSITE****field** **outdoors** **wilderness****× NOT examples****a playground** **a cafeteria** **a gymnasium****Why we use it**

Laboratory comes from the Latin word laborare meaning to work. Knowing Latin roots helps you understand many English words!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**In the _____, the scientists were...**

relied

verb

Word family: rely relies relying relied reliable reliance
unreliable

● What it means

Depended on with full trust or confidence.

In kid words: Trusted something or someone to help you!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The hikers relied on their compass to find the trail through the forest."

relied on friends

relied on a map

relied on experience

✓ Means the SAME

depended

trusted

counted on

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

doubted

distrusted

questioned

✗ NOT examples

doing everything alone

not trusting anyone

ignoring helpful advice



Why we use it

Relied is the past tense of rely. It is an important academic word that shows how people and things depend on each other!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ relied on _____ because...

tournament

noun

Word family: tournament tournaments

● What it means

A series of games or contests in which teams or players compete for an overall prize.

In kid words: A big competition where teams play against each other to see who wins!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Our school entered the regional spelling tournament and placed second."

a chess tournament

the basketball tournament

winning the tournament

✓ Means the SAME

competition

championship

contest

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

practice

scrimmage

rehearsal

✗ NOT examples

a regular practice session

playing alone

a casual game with friends



Why we use it

Tournament is a great word for talking about sports, games, and competitions. It comes from Old French and originally meant a jousting contest!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ won the tournament by...

enormous

adjective

Word family: enormous enormously

● What it means

Extremely large in size, quantity, or extent.

In kid words: Really, really big! Much bigger than normal!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The enormous whale surfaced beside the small fishing boat."

an enormous building

enormous effort

enormous crowd

✓ Means the SAME

huge

massive

gigantic

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

tiny

small

miniature

✗ NOT examples

*a regular-sized pencil**a small insect**a normal lunch*

Why we use it

Enormous is a powerful adjective that can replace overused words like big or large. Using precise adjectives makes your writing more vivid!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ was enormous compared to...

cheetah

noun

Word family: cheetah cheetahs**● What it means**

A large, slender African cat with a tawny coat and black spots, known for being the fastest land animal.

In kid words: A spotted wild cat from Africa that can run super fast!**● Teacher models (I Do)**

"The cheetah can reach speeds of over seventy miles per hour in just a few seconds."

a running cheetah

the cheetah's speed

a mother cheetah and her cubs

✓ Means the SAME

leopard

panther

wildcat

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

tortoise

sloth

snail

✗ NOT examples

a house cat

a slow turtle

a dog at the park

? Why we use it

Learning animal names like cheetah helps you talk about the natural world and practice using comparative and superlative adjectives!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**The cheetah is _____ because...**

sculpture

noun

Word family: sculpture sculptures sculptural

● What it means

A three-dimensional work of art made by carving, molding, or assembling materials.

In kid words: A piece of art you can walk around and see from all sides, like a statue!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The museum displayed a bronze sculpture of a horse galloping through waves."

a marble sculpture

a modern sculpture

the sculptor's sculpture

✓ Means the SAME

statue

carving

figure

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

painting

drawing

photograph

✗ NOT examples

a flat drawing on paper

a photograph on the wall

words in a book

? Why we use it

Sculpture is a great academic vocabulary word for talking about art. It comes from the Latin word sculpere meaning to carve!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ sculpture was interesting because...

volcanoes

noun

Word family: volcano volcanoes volcanic volcanically**● What it means**

Mountains or hills with openings through which lava, rock, and gases erupt from the Earth's interior.

In kid words: Mountains that can shoot out hot melted rock and ash!**● Teacher models (I Do)**

"Scientists have studied volcanoes for centuries to understand how the Earth changes."

active volcanoes

erupting volcanoes

underwater volcanoes

✓ Means the SAME

geysers

vents

craters

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

plains

valleys

flatlands

✗ NOT examples

a regular mountain with snow

a sandy hill

a grassy mound

? Why we use it

Volcanoes is a great science word! Its plural form (volcano to volcanoes) follows a special spelling rule for words ending in -o.

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ have learned about volcanoes because...

praised

verb

● What it means

Expressed warm approval or admiration for someone's achievements.

In kid words: Said nice things about someone's good work!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The principal praised the students who had volunteered at the community garden."

praised the effort

praised her bravery

praised the team

✓ Means the SAME

complimented

commended

applauded

× Means the OPPOSITE

criticized

scolded

blamed

× NOT examples

ignoring someone's hard work

pointing out only mistakes

saying nothing at all

? Why we use it

Praised is used in present perfect tense as has praised. Learning irregular past participles like written, spoken, and driven is essential for forming perfect tenses!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The teacher praised _____ for...

practiced

verb

Word family: practice practices practicing practiced

unpracticed

● What it means

Performed an activity or skill repeatedly in order to improve.

In kid words: Did something over and over to get better at it!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The orchestra has practiced the concert piece for three weeks straight."

practiced the piano

practiced spelling

practiced every day

✓ Means the SAME

rehearsed

trained

drilled

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

neglected

ignored

abandoned

✗ NOT examples

trying something only once

giving up right away

watching others do it

? Why we use it

Practiced is used here as a past participle in the present perfect tense (has practiced). This tense shows an action that started in the past and continues to the present!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ practiced _____ until...

schedule

noun

Word family: **schedule** **schedules** **reschedule**

● What it means

A plan that lists events, activities, or tasks and the times at which they will take place.

In kid words: A list that shows when things will happen, like your class timetable!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The new schedule includes more time for science and art classes."

the daily schedule**a busy schedule****check the schedule**

✓ Means the SAME

timetable**agenda****plan**

× Means the OPPOSITE

chaos**disorder****randomness**

× NOT examples

doing things whenever you feel like it**no plan at all****making it up as you go**

Why we use it

Schedule is a commonly misspelled word because of the 'sch' combination. It is also an important academic word used every day at school!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ checked the schedule to find out...

strategy

noun

Word family: strategy strategies strategic strategically
strategist

● What it means

A plan of action designed to achieve a long-term or overall goal.

In kid words: A smart plan for how to win or reach your goal!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The team developed a new strategy to defend against their opponent's fast attacks."

a winning strategy develop a strategy change the strategy

✓ Means the SAME

plan approach method

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

confusion randomness
aimlessness

✗ NOT examples

playing without a plan guessing randomly
running around without direction

? Why we use it

Strategy is a powerful academic word used in sports, school, and life. It comes from the Greek word strategia meaning generalship!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The team's _____ was to...

audience

noun

Word family: **audience** **audiences**

● What it means

A group of people gathered to watch or listen to a performance, speech, or presentation.

In kid words: The people who come to watch a show or listen to something!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The audience cheered loudly when the young pianist finished her beautiful performance."

a large audience**the audience applauded****performing for an audience**

✓ Means the SAME

spectators

viewers

crowd

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

performers

actors

presenters

✗ NOT examples

*an empty room**the people on stage**someone practicing alone*

? Why we use it

Audience is a collective noun, which means it names a group. Collective nouns can take singular or plural verbs depending on whether the group acts as one unit or as individuals!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The audience _____ because...

exhibit

noun

Word family: exhibit exhibits exhibiting exhibited exhibition

● What it means

A public display of objects, artworks, or artifacts in a museum or gallery.

In kid words: A special display in a museum where you can look at interesting things!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The natural history museum opened a new exhibit about ocean life from millions of years ago."

a science exhibit

the art exhibit

visiting an exhibit

✓ Means the SAME

display

exhibition

showcase

× Means the OPPOSITE

storage

archive

warehouse

× NOT examples

*a box of things in a closet**a pile of unsorted items**books on a shelf at home*

Why we use it

Exhibit can be both a noun (an exhibit) and a verb (to exhibit). It is a great academic word for talking about museums, science fairs, and displays!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ exhibit was fascinating because...

difference

noun

Word family: difference differences indifference**● What it means**

A way in which people or things are not the same.

In kid words: How two things are not alike or not equal!**● Teacher models (I Do)**

"Can you explain the difference between a simile and a metaphor?"

notice the difference

a big difference

the main difference

✓ Means the SAME

distinction

contrast

variation

× Means the OPPOSITE

similarity

sameness

likeness

× NOT examples*two things that look exactly the same**identical twins acting the same way**matching socks***Why we use it**

Difference is a key academic word used in every subject to compare and contrast ideas, objects, and concepts!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**The main _____ between the two is...**

supplies

noun

Word family: **supply** **supplies** **supplying** **supplied** **supplier**

● What it means

Materials, equipment, or provisions needed for a particular purpose or activity.

In kid words: The things you need to do a project or activity!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"We gathered all the supplies we needed for the volcano experiment, including baking soda and vinegar."

art supplies**school supplies****camping supplies**

✓ Means the SAME

materials**equipment****provisions**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

shortage**lack****deficit**

✗ NOT examples

an empty backpack***a desk with nothing on it******a bare shelf***

Why we use it

Supplies is a useful everyday word. Notice how the plural changes from supply to supplies by changing y to i and adding -es!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ needed supplies such as...

technology

noun

Word family: technology technologies

● What it means

The application of scientific knowledge for practical purposes, especially through machines, devices, and systems.

In kid words: Machines, computers, and tools that help people do things better and faster!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The school invested in new technology so every student could use a tablet for learning."

modern technology

using technology

new technology

✓ Means the SAME

innovation

devices

electronics

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

tradition

simplicity

manual labor

✗ NOT examples

writing with a quill pen

washing clothes by hand

sending a letter by horse



Why we use it

Technology comes from the Greek words techne (art/skill) and logos (study). Understanding Greek roots helps you figure out many English words!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The new _____ helped the students...

librarian

noun

Word family: **librarian** **librarians** **librarianship**

● What it means

A person who is trained to work in a library and help people find information and books.

In kid words: A person who works in a library and helps you find books and information!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The librarian helped me find three books about ancient Egypt for my history report."

the school librarian **ask the librarian** **the librarian recommended a book**

✓ Means the SAME

archivist **media specialist**

information specialist

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

patron **borrower** **visitor**

✗ NOT examples

a student reading a book **a person buying books at a store**

someone browsing online

? Why we use it

Librarian comes from the Latin word *liber* meaning book. Notice how library and librarian share the same root!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ asked the librarian for help with...

interesting

adjective

Word family: interest interesting interested uninteresting
interestingly

● What it means

Arousing curiosity or attention; holding one's interest.

In kid words: Something that makes you want to learn more about it!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The teacher shared an interesting article about how dolphins communicate with each other."

an interesting fact really interesting an interesting topic

✓ Means the SAME

fascinating engaging
captivating

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

boring dull uninteresting
tedious

✗ NOT examples

staring at a blank wall counting the same thing over and over
watching paint dry

? Why we use it

Interesting is a commonly misspelled word. Remember: inter-est-ing has three syllables. It is a versatile adjective used in academic writing across all subjects!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I found the _____ interesting because...

competition

noun

Word family: competition competitions**• What it means**

An event or contest in which people try to win by being better, faster, or more skilled than others.

In kid words: A contest where people try to be the best at something!

• Teacher models (I Do)

"The science competition brought students from twelve different countries to present their projects."

a spelling competition

the swimming competition

a friendly competition

✓ Means the SAME

contest

tournament

championship

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

cooperation

collaboration

teamwork

✗ NOT examples

working together as a team

everyone getting the same award

playing just for fun

**Why we use it**

Competition is a commonly misspelled word with the suffix -tion. It combines many Unit 1 skills: irregular plurals (women, men), possessives, present perfect tense, and correlative conjunctions!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ entered the competition because...

previously

adverb

● What it means

At an earlier time; before now.

In kid words: Something that happened before, in the past!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The scientist had previously studied insects before switching to birds."

previously unknown

as previously mentioned

previously visited

✓ Means the SAME

before

earlier

formerly

× Means the OPPOSITE

afterward

later

subsequently

× NOT examples

*something happening right now**a future event**something brand new*

? Why we use it

This word helps you talk about what happened before something else, which is important in storytelling and history!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I had previously _____ before I started...

subsequently

adverb

● What it means

After a particular event or time; following.

In kid words: Something that comes after something else!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"She moved to a new school and subsequently made many friends."

subsequently discovered

subsequently changed

subsequently improved

✓ Means the SAME

afterward

later

then

× Means the OPPOSITE

previously

before

earlier

× NOT examples

*at the same time**happening first**before anything else*

? Why we use it

This word helps you show the order events happen in, which makes your writing clearer and more organized!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

First I _____, and subsequently I...

duration

noun

Word family: duration durations durable endure enduring

• What it means

The length of time something lasts or continues.

In kid words: How long something takes from start to finish!

• Teacher models (I Do)

"The duration of the science experiment was three weeks."

the duration of the movie

for the duration of the trip

a short duration

✓ Means the SAME

length

span

period

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

instant

moment

flash

✗ NOT examples

*a single second**a quick blink**a brief pause*

Why we use it

This word helps you describe how long things take, which is useful in science, history, and everyday life!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The duration of _____ lasted about...

prior

adjective

Word family: prior priority prioritize

● What it means

Existing or coming before in time or order.

In kid words: Something that happened before something else!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Her prior experience with coding helped her build the robot."

prior experience

prior knowledge

prior to the event

✓ Means the SAME

previous

earlier

former

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

later

following

subsequent

✗ NOT examples

*something happening now**a future plan**a current event*

Why we use it

This word is very useful in school when you connect what you already know to new learning!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

My prior knowledge of _____ helped me...

meanwhile

adverb

● What it means

At the same time that something else is happening.

In kid words: While one thing happens, another thing happens too!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The kids played outside; meanwhile, their parents prepared dinner."

meanwhile, back at school

she studied; meanwhile, he played

meanwhile, the rain stopped

✓ Means the SAME

simultaneously

concurrently

at the same time

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

afterward

later

then

✗ NOT examples

events happening one after another

something that happened alone

a single event by itself



Why we use it

This word helps you describe two things happening at the same time, making your stories more interesting!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I was doing _____; meanwhile, my friend was...

interval

noun

Word family: interval intervals

● What it means

A period of time between two events or actions.

In kid words: The time gap between one thing and the next!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"There was a ten-minute interval between the two halves of the soccer game."

a short interval

at regular intervals

the interval between classes

✓ Means the SAME

gap

pause

break

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

continuation

extension

nonstop

✗ NOT examples

*something happening without a break**a continuous action**events with no gap*

Why we use it

This word helps you measure and describe the time between events, which is useful in science, sports, and daily life!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**The interval between _____ and _____ was about...**

eventually

adverb

● What it means

In the end; after a period of time or a series of events.

In kid words: After waiting a while, it finally happens!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"After many tries, she eventually solved the difficult math problem."

eventually finished

eventually learned

eventually succeeded

✓ Means the SAME

finally

ultimately

in time

× Means the OPPOSITE

immediately

instantly

right away

× NOT examples

*something that happens instantly**an immediate result**a sudden change*

Why we use it

This word shows that good things can come with patience and hard work!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I struggled with _____ but eventually I...

consecutive

adjective

Word family: consecutive consecutively**● What it means**

Following one after another without interruption.

In kid words: Things that happen one right after another, with no breaks!**● Teacher models (I Do)**

"The basketball team won five consecutive games this season."

three consecutive days

consecutive wins

consecutive numbers

✓ Means the SAME

successive

sequential

continuous

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

random

scattered

interrupted

✗ NOT examples

skipping days

every other week

random moments

**Why we use it**

This word helps you describe streaks and patterns, like winning streaks in sports or reading every day in a row!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**For _____ consecutive days, I have been...**

chronological

adjective

Word family: **chronological** **chronologically** **chronology**

● What it means

Arranged in the order of time, from earliest to latest.

In kid words: Putting things in time order, from first to last!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The history book presents events in chronological order from ancient times to today."

chronological order **a chronological timeline** **chronological sequence**

✓ Means the SAME

sequential **ordered** **time-based**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

random **disordered** **jumbled**

✗ NOT examples

a mixed-up list **events in random order** **a shuffled playlist**



Why we use it

This word is essential for organizing events in history, science experiments, and telling stories in the right order!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I arranged _____ in chronological order by...

simultaneous

adjective

Word family: simultaneous simultaneously

● What it means

Happening or done at the same time.

In kid words: Two things happening at the exact same moment!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The simultaneous thunderclap and lightning flash startled everyone."

simultaneous events

simultaneous translation

simultaneous actions

✓ Means the SAME

concurrent

parallel

synchronized

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

sequential

separate

consecutive

✗ NOT examples

one event after another

taking turns

events on different days



Why we use it

This word helps you describe things that happen at the exact same time, which is useful in science and storytelling!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ and _____ were simultaneous because...

sequence

noun

Word family: **sequence** **sequences** **sequential** **sequentially**

● What it means

A particular order in which related events or things follow each other.

In kid words: The order things happen in, like steps in a recipe!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The scientist followed the exact sequence of steps to complete the experiment."

in sequence **a sequence of events** **the correct sequence**

✓ Means the SAME

order **series** **progression**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

disorder **chaos** **randomness**

✗ NOT examples

a jumbled mess **random events** **things with no order**



Why we use it

Understanding sequence helps you follow instructions, retell stories, and explain how things happen in order!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The sequence of events was: first _____, then...

passage

noun

Word family: **passage** **passages** **pass** **passing** **bypass**

● What it means

The process of moving from one place or stage to another; also a section of text.

In kid words: Moving from one place to another, or a part of a story you read!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The passage of time had changed the small village into a busy city."

a narrow passage

the passage of time

a passage from a book

✓ Means the SAME

journey

transition

route

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

standstill

halt

blockage

✗ NOT examples

staying in one place

a dead end

being stuck

? Why we use it

This word has two great meanings -- it helps you describe travel AND parts of text you read in class!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The passage from _____ to _____ took about...

transition

noun

Word family: transition transitions transitional**● What it means**

The process of changing from one state, stage, or subject to another.

In kid words: When something changes from one thing to something different!**● Teacher models (I Do)**

"The transition from elementary to middle school can be exciting."

a smooth transition **the transition from summer to fall****a transition period****✓ Means the SAME**

change shift switch

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

stability permanence

constancy

✗ NOT examples

staying the same keeping still no change at all

? Why we use it

This word helps you describe changes in your life, in nature, and in stories!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**The transition from _____ to _____ was...**

era

noun

Word family: era eras

● What it means

A long and distinct period of history with particular characteristics.

In kid words: A big chunk of time in history that has a special name!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"We are living in the digital era of computers and smartphones."

the modern era

the ice age era

a new era

✓ Means the SAME

age

period

epoch

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

moment

instant

second

✗ NOT examples

*a single day**one quick minute**a brief second*

Why we use it

This word helps you talk about big time periods in history and understand how the world has changed!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ era was important because...

commence

verb

Word family: **commence** **commences** **commencing** **commenced**
commencement

● What it means

To begin or start something.

In kid words: To start something, especially something important!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The graduation ceremony will commence at ten o'clock sharp."

commence the ceremony

commence training

commence the project

✓ Means the SAME

begin

start

initiate

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

end

finish

conclude

✗ NOT examples

stopping a game

ending a lesson

wrapping up a project



Why we use it

This is a formal word for 'begin' that you will see in announcements, ceremonies, and official writing!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ will commence when...

anticipate

verb

Word family: anticipate anticipates anticipating anticipated
anticipation

● What it means

To expect or look forward to something that is going to happen.

In kid words: To think about something before it happens and get ready for it!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The students eagerly anticipate the field trip to the science museum."

anticipate the results eagerly anticipate anticipate a challenge

✓ Means the SAME

expect predict foresee

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

ignore overlook disregard

✗ NOT examples

being surprised by everything never thinking ahead not planning at all



Why we use it

This word helps you talk about thinking ahead and making predictions, which is a great thinking skill!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I anticipate _____ will happen because...

condition

noun

Word family: **condition** **conditions** **conditional** **conditionally**
unconditional **recondition**

● What it means

A state of being or a requirement that must be met for something to happen.

In kid words: Something that has to be true for another thing to happen!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The icy road conditions made driving difficult during the winter storm."

weather conditions **a necessary condition** **in good condition**

✓ Means the SAME

requirement **situation**

circumstance

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

unconditional **guarantee**

certainty

✗ NOT examples

something that happens no matter what *a sure thing*

an unconditional promise

? Why we use it

Understanding conditions helps you with 'if-then' thinking in science, math, and everyday decisions!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The condition for _____ to happen is...

precede verb

Word family: precede precedes preceding preceded precedent
unprecedented

● What it means

To come before something in time, order, or position.

In kid words: To happen before something else!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"A loud rumble preceded the earthquake that shook the buildings."

precede the meeting thunder precedes lightning

the events that preceded the change

✓ Means the SAME

come before lead forego

× Means the OPPOSITE

follow succeed come after

× NOT examples

coming after someone following behind happening last

? Why we use it

This word helps you explain cause and effect and show what happened first in a sequence of events!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The event that preceded _____ was...

observe

verb

Word family: observe observes observing observed observer
observation observant

● What it means

To watch carefully or notice something with attention.

In kid words: To look at something very carefully to learn about it!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The students used magnifying glasses to observe the tiny insects."

observe the experiment

observe the stars

observe changes

✓ Means the SAME

watch

notice

examine

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

ignore

overlook

neglect

✗ NOT examples

not paying attention

looking away

missing the details



Why we use it

Scientists observe things to make discoveries, and you can too!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

When I observe _____, I notice that...

distinction

noun

Word family: distinction distinctions**What it means**

A clear difference between two or more things.

In kid words: What makes one thing different from another!**Teacher models (I Do)**

"There is an important distinction between the present perfect and the simple past tense."

an important distinction

the distinction between right and wrong

a clear distinction

✓ Means the SAME

difference

contrast

variation

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

similarity

sameness

likeness

✗ NOT examples

things that are exactly the same

two identical copies

no difference at all

**Why we use it**

This word helps you explain differences clearly, which is essential for comparing and contrasting in school!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The distinction between _____ and _____ is...

progression

noun

Word family: **progression** **progressions**

● What it means

The process of developing or moving gradually toward a more advanced state.

In kid words: Getting better and better at something over time!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Her progression from beginner to expert took three years of hard practice."

a natural progression

the progression of skills

steady progression

✓ Means the SAME

advancement

development

growth

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

regression

decline

deterioration

✗ NOT examples

going backward

getting worse

losing skills



Why we use it

This word reminds you that learning is a journey and everyone progresses at their own pace!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

My progression in _____ has shown that...

persevere

verb

Word family: **persevere** **perseveres** **persevering** **persevered**
perseverance

● What it means

To continue doing something even when it is difficult or takes a long time.

In kid words: To keep trying even when things get really hard!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The climbers had to persevere through terrible snowstorms to reach the top."

persevere through challenges **persevere in learning**

persevere despite setbacks

✓ Means the SAME

persist **endure** **continue**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

quit **surrender** **give up**

✗ NOT examples

giving up easily ***stopping when it gets hard*** ***quitting after one try***



Why we use it

This is one of the most important words you can learn because perseverance is the key to achieving your goals!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I had to persevere when _____ because...

innovation

noun

Word family: **innovation** **innovations**

● What it means

A new idea, method, or invention that changes how things are done.

In kid words: A brand new idea or invention that makes things better!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The smartphone was an incredible innovation that changed how people communicate."

a technological innovation**innovation in medicine****an amazing innovation**

✓ Means the SAME

invention **breakthrough****advancement**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

tradition **stagnation****convention**

✗ NOT examples

*doing things the old way**copying someone else**keeping everything the same*

Why we use it

This word helps you talk about new ideas and inventions that make the world a better place!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**An important innovation in _____ has been...**

accomplish

verb

Word family: **accomplish** **accomplishes** **accomplishing**
accomplished **accomplishment**

● What it means

To succeed in completing or achieving something.

In kid words: To finish something you worked hard on!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"By the end of the year, the class will have accomplished all of their learning goals."

accomplish a goal **accomplish the mission** **accomplish great things**

✓ Means the SAME

achieve **complete** **fulfill**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

fail **abandon** **neglect**

✗ NOT examples

quitting halfway **leaving something unfinished** **not trying at all**



Why we use it

This word celebrates your hard work and reminds you to be proud of what you finish and achieve!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

Something I have accomplished this year is...

culminate

verb

Word family: **culminate** **culminates** **culminating** **culminated**
culmination

● What it means

To reach the highest point or final result after a period of development.

In kid words: When everything builds up to a big finish!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Months of hard work will culminate in the school science fair next week."

culminate in a performance **culminate in success**

the project culminated in an award

✓ Means the SAME

conclude **climax** **peak**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

begin **start** **commence**

✗ NOT examples

just getting started **the very beginning** **the first step**



Why we use it

This word helps you describe how all your hard work leads to an exciting final result or achievement!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

Our _____ will culminate in...

furthermore

adverb

● What it means

In addition to what has already been stated; moreover.

In kid words: A fancy way to say 'also' or 'and another thing!'

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The planet Mars is cold. Furthermore, it has very thin air."

furthermore, the data shows

furthermore, we discovered

furthermore, the team agreed

✓ Means the SAME

moreover

additionally

also

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

however

nevertheless

conversely

✗ NOT examples

changing the subject

disagreeing with a point

ending a discussion



Why we use it

Helps you add more information to make your writing stronger and more detailed!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ was important. Furthermore, it also...

consequently

adverb

● What it means

As a result; therefore.

In kid words: Because of that, this happened!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The ocean was rough. Consequently, the boat stayed in the harbor."

consequently, we left early

consequently, the game was canceled

consequently, they changed plans

✓ Means the SAME

therefore

thus

as a result

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

regardless

nevertheless

despite

✗ NOT examples

something unrelated happening

an event with no cause

a random coincidence



Why we use it

Shows how one event causes another, making your writing logical and clear!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ happened. Consequently...

nevertheless

adverb

● What it means

In spite of that; notwithstanding; all the same.

In kid words: Even so, it still happened!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The music was difficult. Nevertheless, the students practiced until they mastered it."

nevertheless, she continued

nevertheless, the show went on

nevertheless, they succeeded

✓ Means the SAME

however

nonetheless

still

× Means the OPPOSITE

therefore

consequently

accordingly

× NOT examples

giving up because of a problem

stopping after a setback

quitting easily



Why we use it

Shows that something happened even when it was hard or unexpected!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ was challenging. Nevertheless...

whereas

conjunction

● What it means

In contrast or comparison with the fact that.

In kid words: On the other hand; but comparing two things!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The old machine was slow, whereas the new invention worked quickly."

whereas others disagreed

whereas the old one was slow

whereas some prefer summer

✓ Means the SAME

while

although

but

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

similarly

likewise

equally

✗ NOT examples

two things that are the same

no comparison being made

agreeing with someone



Why we use it

Helps you compare two different things clearly in one sentence!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ was one way, whereas the _____ was...

although

conjunction

● What it means

In spite of the fact that; even though.

In kid words: Even though something is true, something else is also true!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Although the musician was nervous, both she and the artist performed beautifully."

although it rained

although she was tired

although the test was hard

✓ Means the SAME

though

even though

despite

× Means the OPPOSITE

because

since

therefore

× NOT examples

*agreeing without any contrast**two ideas that match perfectly**a simple cause and effect*

? Why we use it

Lets you show that two things can be true at the same time, even when they seem to conflict!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

Although the _____ seemed difficult...

moreover

adverb

● What it means

In addition; besides; what is more.

In kid words: And also; plus there is more to say!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The art class was fun. Moreover, the students learned about famous painters."

moreover, the painting was beautiful

moreover, the class enjoyed it

moreover, the teacher agreed

✓ Means the SAME

furthermore

additionally

besides

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

however

nevertheless

conversely

✗ NOT examples

subtracting information

making a point weaker

ending a discussion



Why we use it

Adds extra information to make your argument or explanation even stronger!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ was interesting. Moreover...

hence

adverb

● What it means

As a consequence; for this reason; therefore.

In kid words: So, because of that!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The ocean is vast and deep. Hence, many creatures remain undiscovered."

hence the delay

hence the excitement

hence the name

✓ Means the SAME

therefore

thus

consequently

× Means the OPPOSITE

regardless

nevertheless

notwithstanding

× NOT examples

something unrelated

a random event

no clear cause

? Why we use it

A short, powerful word that explains why something happened because of something else!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ caused a problem. Hence...

thereby

adverb

● What it means

By that means; as a result of that.

In kid words: By doing that, something else happens!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The museum displayed the artifacts, thereby teaching visitors about ancient cultures."

thereby solving the problem

thereby helping others

thereby saving time

✓ Means the SAME

thus

therefore

consequently

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

regardless

despite

notwithstanding

✗ NOT examples

doing something with no result

an action that changes nothing

a meaningless step



Why we use it

Shows how doing one thing leads directly to a result, connecting cause and effect!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

She completed the _____, thereby...

alternatively

adverb

● What it means

As another choice or possibility; on the other hand.

In kid words: Or, you could do this instead!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The rocket could fly to Mars. Alternatively, it could orbit Earth to collect data."

alternatively, we could walk

alternatively, try the other path

alternatively, use a different method

✓ Means the SAME

instead

otherwise

or

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

definitely

certainly

absolutely

✗ NOT examples

having no other option

being forced into one choice

no other way possible

? Why we use it

Offers another option or possibility, showing readers there is more than one way to do something!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

We could _____. Alternatively, we could...

regardless

adverb

● What it means

Without paying attention to the present situation; despite the prevailing circumstances.

In kid words: No matter what happens, it still goes on!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The coral reef was damaged. Regardless, the fish continued to search for new homes."

regardless of the weather

regardless of the cost

regardless of the challenges

✓ Means the SAME

anyway

nevertheless

nonetheless

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

therefore

consequently

accordingly

✗ NOT examples

quitting because of obstacles

changing your mind due to problems

stopping when things get hard



Why we use it

Shows determination and persistence, no matter what challenges come up!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The _____ faced many problems. Regardless...

significant

adjective

Word family: significant significantly significance signify
insignificant

● What it means

Large enough to be important or have a noticeable effect.

In kid words: Something that really matters and makes a big difference!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The scientist made a significant discovery that changed how we understand the ocean."

a significant discovery significant progress a significant change

✓ Means the SAME

important major notable

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

minor trivial insignificant

✗ NOT examples

a small scratch a tiny drop a brief pause



Why we use it

Recognizing what is significant helps you focus on what really matters!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

A significant event in my life was when...

inevitable

adjective

Word family: inevitable inevitably inevitability

● What it means

Certain to happen; unavoidable.

In kid words: Something that is definitely going to happen no matter what!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Change is inevitable as we grow older and learn new things."

an inevitable outcome

inevitable changes

an inevitable conclusion

✓ Means the SAME

unavoidable

certain

inescapable

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

avoidable

preventable

uncertain

✗ NOT examples

a surprise party

a random event

an unexpected gift

? Why we use it

Understanding what is inevitable helps you prepare for the future!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

It was inevitable that _____ would happen because...

resilient

adjective

Word family: resilient resiliently resilience

● What it means

Able to recover quickly from difficulties; tough and adaptable.

In kid words: Being strong enough to bounce back when things get hard!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The resilient students kept studying even after the power went out."

a resilient student

resilient communities

a resilient ecosystem

✓ Means the SAME

tough

adaptable

hardy

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

fragile

weak

vulnerable

✗ NOT examples

a glass vase

a wilted flower

a broken bridge



Why we use it

Being resilient helps you overcome challenges and keep growing!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I showed I was resilient when I...

contrast

noun

Word family: **contrast** **contrasts** **contrasting** **contrasted**

● What it means

The state of being strikingly different from something else when compared.

In kid words: How two things are different from each other!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"There is a clear contrast between summer and winter temperatures."

a sharp contrast **in contrast to** **by contrast**

✓ Means the SAME

difference **distinction**

opposition

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

similarity **likeness**

resemblance

✗ NOT examples

identical twins **matching socks** **two copies of the same book**



Why we use it

Noticing contrasts helps you compare and understand ideas better!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The contrast between _____ and _____ is that...

independent

adjective

Word family: **depend** **dependent** **independent** **independently**
independence

● What it means

Not depending on another; able to stand alone or function by itself.

In kid words: Something that can work all by itself without needing help!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"An independent clause can stand alone as a complete sentence."

an independent clause **an independent thinker** **an independent country**

✓ Means the SAME

self-sufficient **autonomous**

free

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

dependent **reliant** **subordinate**

✗ NOT examples

a baby bird **training wheels** **following instructions exactly**

? Why we use it

Understanding independence in grammar helps you build stronger sentences!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I feel independent when I...

complex

adjective

Word family: complex complexes complexity complexly

● What it means

Consisting of many interconnected parts; not simple.

In kid words: Something that has many parts and is not easy to figure out!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The human brain is a complex organ with billions of connections."

a complex problem

a complex sentence

a complex system

✓ Means the SAME

complicated

intricate

elaborate

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

simple

basic

straightforward

✗ NOT examples

a plain circle

adding 1+1

a single straight line



Why we use it

Learning to handle complex ideas makes you a stronger thinker!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

This problem is complex because...

expand

verb

Word family: expand expands expanding expanded expansion
expandable

● What it means

To increase in size, amount, or detail; to make larger or more complete.

In kid words: Making something bigger or adding more details to it!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"You can expand a simple sentence by adding adjectives and prepositional phrases."

expand a sentence expand your vocabulary expand an idea

✓ Means the SAME

enlarge extend broaden

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

shrink reduce contract

✗ NOT examples

cutting a paragraph removing words shortening a story

? Why we use it

Expanding sentences makes your writing more interesting and detailed!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I expanded my sentence by adding...

modify

verb

Word family: **modify** **modifies** **modifying** **modified** **modification**
modifier

● What it means

To make partial changes to something; to alter without transforming completely.

In kid words: Changing something a little bit to make it better or different!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"You can modify the sentence by adding an introductory clause."

modify a sentence**modify behavior****modify a recipe**

✓ Means the SAME

adjust**alter****adapt**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

preserve**maintain****keep**

✗ NOT examples

leaving it exactly the same**ignoring changes****destroying completely**

Why we use it

Knowing how to modify sentences gives you power over your writing style!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I modified my writing by...

condense

verb

Word family: **condense** **condenses** **condensing** **condensed**
condensation

● What it means

To make something denser, shorter, or more concise; to compress.

In kid words: Making something shorter by keeping only the most important parts!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The editor asked the writer to condense the five-page report into two pages."

condense a paragraph**condense information****condense a report**

✓ Means the SAME

shorten**compress****summarize**

× Means the OPPOSITE

expand**lengthen****elaborate**

× NOT examples

adding extra pages**writing more words****repeating yourself**

Why we use it

Condensing helps you communicate the most important ideas clearly!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I can condense this paragraph by...

essential

adjective

Word family: essential essentially essence nonessential

● What it means

Absolutely necessary; extremely important.

In kid words: Something you really, truly need and cannot do without!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Water is essential for all living things on Earth."

essential supplies

essential skills

an essential part

✓ Means the SAME

necessary

vital

crucial

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

unnecessary

optional

nonessential

unimportant

✗ NOT examples

a decoration

a bonus feature

extra toppings

? Why we use it

Knowing what is essential helps you make smart decisions!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I think _____ is essential because...

abundant

adjective

Word family: abundant abundantly abundance

● What it means

Existing or available in large quantities; plentiful.

In kid words: So much of something that there is more than enough!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The rainforest has abundant plant and animal species."

abundant resources

abundant sunshine

abundant wildlife

✓ Means the SAME

plentiful

copious

ample

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

scarce

rare

limited

✗ NOT examples

*a desert with no water**an empty shelf**a bare tree in winter*

Why we use it

Describing things as abundant helps readers picture how much there is!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

Our school has abundant opportunities to...

exclamation

noun

Word family: exclamation exclamations

● What it means

A sudden cry or remark expressing strong emotion or surprise.

In kid words: A word or short sentence you say loudly when you feel something strongly!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The exclamation 'Hooray!' showed how excited the crowd was about the victory."

an exclamation of joy

a surprised exclamation

a loud exclamation

✓ Means the SAME

outcry

interjection

shout

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

whisper

murmur

silence

✗ NOT examples

a quiet thought

a written paragraph

a math equation



Why we use it

Exclamations add emotion and energy to your writing and speech!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

When I am surprised, my exclamation is usually...

clause

noun

Word family: clause clauses**● What it means**

A group of words containing a subject and a verb that forms part of a sentence.

In kid words: A piece of a sentence that has its own subject and action!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"In the sentence 'When it rained, we stayed inside,' there are two clauses."

an independent clause

a dependent clause

a relative clause

✓ Means the SAME

phrase

expression

sentence part

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

word

letter

syllable

✗ NOT examples

a single word

a punctuation mark

a blank space

**Why we use it**

Understanding clauses helps you build complex, interesting sentences!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**The dependent clause in this sentence is...**

comprehensive

adjective

Word family: comprehensive comprehensively comprehend
comprehension

● What it means

Including or dealing with all or nearly all aspects of something; complete.

In kid words: Covering everything from start to finish with nothing left out!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The teacher gave a comprehensive review before the final exam."

a comprehensive review

comprehensive knowledge

a comprehensive guide

✓ Means the SAME

thorough

complete

exhaustive

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

partial

incomplete

limited

✗ NOT examples

a quick glance

half a chapter

one side of a story

? Why we use it

Being comprehensive means you do not miss important details!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

A comprehensive study of _____ would include...

mastery

noun

Word family: master mastered mastering mastery masterful

● What it means

Comprehensive knowledge or skill in a subject or accomplishment.

In kid words: Being so good at something that you really know it inside and out!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"After years of practice, she achieved mastery of three languages."

achieve mastery

language mastery

mastery of a skill

✓ Means the SAME

expertise

command

proficiency

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

ignorance

incompetence

inexperience

✗ NOT examples

*just starting**a beginner level**knowing nothing*

Why we use it

Mastery is the ultimate goal of learning anything new!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I am working toward mastery of...

revise

verb

Word family: revise revises revising revised revision

● What it means

To change or improve a piece of writing by reading it again carefully.

In kid words: Fix up your writing to make it better!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Please revise your paragraph before turning it in."

revise an essay

revise your draft

revise before submitting

✓ Means the SAME

edit

improve

rework

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

ignore

neglect

leave

✗ NOT examples

*hand in without checking**never look at it again**skip proofreading*

Why we use it

Revising helps you catch mistakes and make your ideas clearer!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I need to revise my writing because...

clarify

verb

Word family: clarify clarifies clarifying clarified clarification

clarity

● What it means

To make something easier to understand by explaining it more clearly.

In kid words: Make something clearer so people get it!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Can you clarify what the assignment requires?"

clarify the directions

clarify your answer

clarify the rules

✓ Means the SAME

explain

simplify

illuminate

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

confuse

complicate

obscure

✗ NOT examples

*make things harder to understand**add more confusion**mumble an answer*

Why we use it

Clarifying helps everyone understand exactly what you mean!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

Let me clarify what I mean by...

elaborate

verb

Word family: elaborate elaborates elaborating elaborated
elaboration elaborately

● What it means

To add more details or information to explain something better.

In kid words: Give more details to make your answer bigger and better!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Could you elaborate on your favorite part of the story?"

elaborate on your idea please elaborate elaborate your answer

✓ Means the SAME

expand develop detail

× Means the OPPOSITE

summarize shorten simplify

× NOT examples

give a one-word answer skip the details say nothing more



Why we use it

Elaborating makes your writing richer and more interesting!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

Let me elaborate on...

precise

adjective

Word family: precise precisely precision imprecise

● What it means

Exact and accurate in every detail.

In kid words: Exactly right, not a tiny bit off!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The scientist took precise measurements of the liquid."

a precise measurement precise instructions a precise answer

✓ Means the SAME

exact accurate specific

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

vague imprecise approximate

✗ NOT examples

a rough guess close enough somewhere around there



Why we use it

Being precise helps others understand exactly what you mean!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

It is important to be precise when...

concise

adjective

Word family: **concise** **concisely** **conciseness**

● What it means

Giving information clearly using only a few words.

In kid words: Short and to the point!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Write a concise paragraph about your favorite hobby."

a concise summary**concise writing****a concise explanation**

✓ Means the SAME

brief**short****succinct**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

wordy**lengthy****rambling**

✗ NOT examples

a five-page answer to a simple question***going on and on******repeating the same thing***

Why we use it

Being concise keeps your reader interested and focused!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

A concise way to say that is...

punctuate

verb

Word family: **punctuate** **punctuates** **punctuating** **punctuated**
punctuation

● What it means

To add punctuation marks like commas, periods, and question marks to writing.

In kid words: Put the dots, commas, and marks in the right places!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Remember to punctuate your sentences with proper end marks."

punctuate a sentence **punctuate correctly** **punctuate dialogue**

✓ Means the SAME

mark **notate** **annotate**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

ignore **omit** **skip**

✗ NOT examples

writing with no periods or commas *leaving out all marks*

forgetting every comma



Why we use it

Punctuation helps readers understand where ideas start and stop!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I need to punctuate this sentence by...

emphasize

verb

Word family: **emphasize** **emphasizes** **emphasizing** **emphasized**
emphasis **emphatic**

● What it means

To give special importance or attention to something.

In kid words: Make something stand out so people notice it!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The teacher wanted to emphasize the importance of studying."

emphasize a point **emphasize the main idea** **emphasize key words**

✓ Means the SAME

stress **highlight** **underline**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

downplay **ignore** **overlook**

✗ NOT examples

whisper past the important part **hide the main idea** **bury the details**



Why we use it

Emphasizing helps your audience pay attention to what matters most!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I want to emphasize that...

distinguish

verb

Word family: **distinguish** **distinguishes** **distinguishing**
distinguished **distinguishable**

● What it means

To recognize or notice a difference between things.

In kid words: Tell things apart from each other!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Can you distinguish between a simile and a metaphor?"

distinguish between facts and opinions **distinguish the sounds**

distinguish right from wrong

✓ Means the SAME

differentiate

separate

identify

× Means the OPPOSITE

confuse

mix up

overlook

× NOT examples

thinking everything is the same

mixing up two ideas

not seeing any difference



Why we use it

Distinguishing helps you think carefully and make smart choices!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I can distinguish between these two things because...

address

verb

Word family: address addresses addressing addressed

● What it means

To speak to someone directly or to deal with a matter.

In kid words: Talking to someone by name or dealing with something important!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Please address your concerns to the teacher during office hours."

address a person

address a problem

address the class

✓ Means the SAME

speak to

handle

tackle

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

ignore

avoid

neglect

✗ NOT examples

walking away

pretending not to hear

hiding from a problem



Why we use it

Addressing people and problems directly shows confidence and respect!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I would like to address the issue of...

articulate

verb

Word family: **articulate** **articulates** **articulating** **articulated**
articulation **inarticulate**

● What it means

To express an idea clearly and effectively in words.

In kid words: Say what you think in a clear, easy-to-understand way!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"She was able to articulate her opinion during the class debate."

articulate your thoughts**articulate the answer****articulate a plan**

✓ Means the SAME

express**state****communicate**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

mumble**stammer****confuse**

✗ NOT examples

speaking in a jumbled way***trailing off mid-sentence******using unclear words***

Why we use it

Articulating helps you share your ideas so everyone understands!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I want to articulate my idea about...

illuminate

verb

Word family: illuminate illuminates illuminating illuminated
illuminator illumination

● What it means

To light up; to make something clear or easier to understand.

In kid words: To shine a light on something so everyone can see or understand it!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The teacher used a diagram to illuminate the difficult concept for the class."

illuminate a room illuminate a concept illuminate the path

✓ Means the SAME

clarify brighten explain

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

darken obscure confuse

✗ NOT examples

turning off lights hiding information covering windows



Why we use it

Illuminating ideas helps everyone understand even the hardest topics!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The example helped illuminate the meaning of...

explicit

adjective

Word family: explicit explicitly implicit

● What it means

Stated clearly and in detail, leaving no room for confusion or doubt.

In kid words: When something is said so clearly that there is no way to misunderstand it!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The teacher gave explicit instructions so every student knew exactly what to do."

explicit instructions

explicit directions

an explicit statement

✓ Means the SAME

clear

direct

unambiguous

× Means the OPPOSITE

vague

implicit

unclear

× NOT examples

a hint

a riddle

a shrug



Why we use it

Being explicit helps prevent misunderstandings in communication!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I prefer explicit directions because...

annotate

verb

Word family: **annotate** **annotates** **annotating** **annotated**
annotation

● What it means

To add notes or comments to a text to explain or highlight information.

In kid words: Writing little notes on a text to help you understand it better!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The teacher asked us to annotate the article with questions and observations."

annotate a poem **annotate a diagram** **annotate a map**

✓ Means the SAME

note **comment** **mark up**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

ignore **overlook** **skim**

✗ NOT examples

erasing text **skipping pages** **closing a book**

? Why we use it

Annotating helps you understand and remember what you read!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I like to annotate when I read because...

convey

verb

Word family: convey conveys conveying conveyed**● What it means**

To communicate or express a message, idea, or feeling.

In kid words: To get your message across to someone else!**● Teacher models (I Do)**

"The artist used bright colors to convey a feeling of joy."

convey a message

convey emotions

convey meaning

✓ Means the SAME

communicate

express

transmit

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

conceal

withhold

suppress

✗ NOT examples*keeping a secret**staying silent**hiding your face***Why we use it**

Conveying ideas clearly is one of the most important skills in life!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**I can convey my ideas by...**

coherent

adjective

Word family: **coherent** **coherently** **coherence** **incoherent**

● **What it means**

Logical, consistent, and forming a unified whole; easy to follow.

In kid words: When your writing makes sense and everything connects together!

● **Teacher models (I Do)**

"Her essay presented a coherent argument that convinced the entire class."

a coherent argument

a coherent paragraph

a coherent explanation

✓ **Means the SAME**

logical

clear

consistent

✗ **Means the OPPOSITE**

confusing

disjointed

incoherent

✗ **NOT examples**

random words

mixed-up sentences

contradicting ideas



Why we use it

Coherent writing helps readers understand your ideas easily!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

My writing becomes more coherent when I...

quotation

noun

Word family: quote quotes quoting quoted quotation

quotations

● What it means

A group of words taken from a text or speech and repeated by someone other than the original author.

In kid words: The exact words someone said or wrote, shown with special marks!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The student included a quotation from the president in her essay."

a famous quotation

a direct quotation

a quotation from a book

✓ Means the SAME

quote

citation

excerpt

× Means the OPPOSITE

paraphrase

summary

original words

× NOT examples

your own opinion

a made-up sentence

a random guess



Why we use it

Using quotations makes your writing more powerful and credible!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

My favorite quotation is _____ because...

format

verb

Word family: **format** **formats** **formatting** **formatted**

● What it means

To arrange or put into a specific form or layout.

In kid words: Setting up how something looks on a page, like titles and paragraphs!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Remember to format the title of a book in italics when you write an essay."

format a document**format a title****format an essay**

✓ Means the SAME

arrange**organize****structure**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

disorganize**jumble****mess up**

✗ NOT examples

crumpling paper**scribbling randomly****ignoring instructions**

Why we use it

Proper formatting makes your writing look professional and polished!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**I need to format my essay by...**

cite

verb

Word family: cite cites citing cited citation

● What it means

To quote or refer to a source as evidence or authority.

In kid words: Mentioning where you found your information to prove it is true!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Always cite your sources when writing a research paper."

cite a source

cite evidence

cite an author

✓ Means the SAME

reference

quote

mention

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

plagiarize

fabricate

ignore

✗ NOT examples

*making things up**guessing without proof**hiding your sources*

Why we use it

Citing sources makes your writing trustworthy and credible!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I need to cite _____ because...

enumerate

verb

Word family: **enumerate** **enumerates** **enumerating** **enumerated**
enumeration

● What it means

To mention items one by one; to list.

In kid words: Counting things off one at a time in a list!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The teacher asked the students to enumerate the steps of the scientific method."

enumerate reasons **enumerate steps** **enumerate examples**

✓ Means the SAME

list **count** **itemize**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

summarize **generalize**

lump together

✗ NOT examples

saying everything at once **skipping details** **giving no examples**



Why we use it

Enumerating helps you organize your thoughts clearly and completely!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

Let me enumerate the reasons why...

attribute

verb

Word family: attribute attributes attributing attributed
attribution

● What it means

To regard something as being caused by or belonging to someone or something.

In kid words: Giving credit to the person or thing responsible for something!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Be sure to attribute the quotation to the correct author in your essay."

attribute a quote attribute success attribute a discovery

✓ Means the SAME

credit assign ascribe

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

deny disclaim disown

✗ NOT examples

taking credit falsely ignoring the source plagiarizing



Why we use it

Attributing ideas to their source shows honesty and respect in writing!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I would attribute this success to...

formulate

verb

Word family: **formula** **formulate** **formulates** **formulating**
formulated **formulation**

● What it means

To create or devise something methodically; to put into a clear form.

In kid words: To carefully think up and create a plan or idea!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The scientists needed to formulate a new theory about climate change."

formulate a hypothesis**formulate a plan****formulate a response**

✓ Means the SAME

devise**develop****create**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

destroy**dismantle****neglect**

✗ NOT examples

guessing randomly**ignoring a problem****copying answers**

Why we use it

Formulating ideas helps you think clearly and solve problems!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

Our team had to formulate a plan to...

acronym

noun

Word family: **acronym** **acronyms**

● What it means

A word formed from the first letters of a group of words.

In kid words: A short word made from the first letters of other words, like NASA!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"NASA is an acronym for the National Aeronautics and Space Administration."

NASA**SCUBA****ASAP**

✓ Means the SAME

abbreviation

initialism

shortening

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

full name

complete phrase

spelled-out form

✗ NOT examples

*a full sentence**a paragraph**a complete word*

? Why we use it

Knowing acronyms helps you understand abbreviations used everywhere!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

An acronym I use often is _____ which stands for...

succinct

adjective

Word family: succinct succinctly succinctness

● What it means

Briefly and clearly expressed; using few words to say a lot.

In kid words: Saying exactly what you mean without extra words!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The student gave a succinct answer that impressed the teacher."

a succinct summary

a succinct reply

a succinct definition

✓ Means the SAME

brief

terse

compact

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

wordy

lengthy

verbose

✗ NOT examples

*a rambling speech**a long-winded email**pages of repetition*

Why we use it

Being succinct shows you truly understand a topic!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

A succinct way to say that would be...

meticulous

adjective

Word family: meticulous meticulously

- What it means

Showing great attention to detail; very careful and precise.

In kid words: Being super careful about every tiny detail!

- Teacher models (I Do)

"The meticulous editor checked every sentence for errors before publishing."

meticulous work

a meticulous plan

meticulous handwriting

- ✓ Means the SAME

thorough

careful

detailed

- ✗ Means the OPPOSITE

careless

sloppy

hasty

- ✗ NOT examples

a messy room

a rushed drawing

scribbled notes



Why we use it

Being meticulous helps you produce excellent work with no mistakes!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I am meticulous when I...

proficiency

noun

Word family: proficiency proficiencies**● What it means**

A high degree of skill or expertise in something.

In kid words: Being really good at something because you practiced a lot!**● Teacher models (I Do)**

"Her proficiency in three languages impressed everyone at the international fair."

reading proficiency

language proficiency

math proficiency

✓ Means the SAME

skill

expertise

mastery

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

inability

weakness

incompetence

✗ NOT examples*a first attempt**a beginner mistake**never trying***Why we use it**

Building proficiency means you are becoming an expert!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**I am building proficiency in _____ by...**

derive

verb

Word family: **derive** **derives** **deriving** **derived** **derivation**
derivative

● What it means

To obtain or receive something from a source or origin.

In kid words: To get something from where it started!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The word 'photograph' derives from two Greek roots meaning 'light' and 'write.'"

derive meaning**derive from Greek****derive pleasure**

✓ Means the SAME

obtain**originate****stem**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

give**contribute****supply**

✗ NOT examples

creating something brand new**making something up****inventing from nothing**

Why we use it

Understanding where words come from helps you figure out new vocabulary!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

Many English words derive from...

etymology

noun

Word family: etymology etymologies etymological**● What it means**

The study of the origin and history of words.

In kid words: Learning where words came from!**● Teacher models (I Do)**

"The etymology of 'telephone' shows it comes from Greek roots meaning 'far' and 'sound.'"

word etymology

study etymology

fascinating etymology

✓ Means the SAME

word history

word origin

derivation

× Means the OPPOSITE

modern slang

new coinage

invented term

× NOT examples

the definition of a word

how to pronounce a word

a spelling rule

**Why we use it**

Knowing etymology helps you decode unfamiliar words like a detective!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**The etymology of this word is interesting because...**

interpret

verb

Word family: interpret interprets interpreting interpreted
interpretation interpreter misinterpret

● What it means

To explain the meaning of something or understand it in a particular way.

In kid words: To figure out what something means!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"You can interpret the autobiography to learn about the author's life."

interpret a story interpret data interpret meaning

✓ Means the SAME

explain understand decode

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

misunderstand confuse
misread

✗ NOT examples

ignoring what something means skipping over details
not paying attention

? Why we use it

Interpreting helps you find deeper meaning in what you read!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I interpret this passage to mean...

literal

adjective

Word family: **literal** **literally**

● What it means

Taking words in their usual or most basic sense, without exaggeration or metaphor.

In kid words: Meaning exactly what the words say!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The literal meaning of 'dictate' is 'to say or speak,' from the Latin root 'dict.'"

literal meaning**literal translation****literal sense**

✓ Means the SAME

exact**actual****precise**

× Means the OPPOSITE

figurative**metaphorical****symbolic**

× NOT examples

a joke or exaggeration***a simile or metaphor******an idiom***

Why we use it

Knowing the literal meaning helps you understand figurative language too!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**The literal meaning of this word is...**

figurative

adjective

Word family: figurative figuratively

● What it means

Using words in a way that is different from their usual meaning to create a special effect.

In kid words: Words that paint a picture but don't mean exactly what they say!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Saying 'the cargo weighed a ton' is figurative if it didn't literally weigh two thousand pounds."

figurative language

figurative meaning

figurative expression

✓ Means the SAME

metaphorical

symbolic

nonliteral

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

literal

exact

actual

✗ NOT examples

saying exactly what you mean

dictionary definitions

plain descriptions



Why we use it

Figurative language makes writing vivid and interesting!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

This phrase is figurative because...

perspective

noun

Word family: perspective perspectives**● What it means**

A particular way of thinking about or looking at something; a point of view.

In kid words: The way you see and think about things based on your own experience!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Traveling to other countries gave her a new perspective on the world."

a new perspective

from my perspective

a different perspective

✓ Means the SAME

viewpoint

outlook

standpoint

× Means the OPPOSITE

bias

narrow-mindedness

tunnel vision

× NOT examples

ignoring all opinions

seeing only one side

refusing to listen

**Why we use it**

Understanding different perspectives helps you think more deeply and fairly!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**From my perspective, I think _____ because...**

metaphor

noun

Word family: metaphor metaphors metaphorical metaphorically

● What it means

A figure of speech that compares two unlike things by saying one thing IS another, without using 'like' or 'as.'

In kid words: Saying something IS something else to make a picture in your mind!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Saying 'the bridge was a lifeline for the explorers' is a metaphor comparing a bridge to a lifeline."

powerful metaphor

use a metaphor

extended metaphor

✓ Means the SAME

comparison

figure of speech

analogy

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

literal statement

plain description

factual report

✗ NOT examples

a comparison using 'like' or 'as' (that's a simile)

a dictionary definition

a plain fact



Why we use it

Metaphors make your writing come alive by creating vivid mental pictures!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

This metaphor compares...

symbolize

verb

Word family: symbol symbols symbolize symbolizes symbolized
symbolic

● What it means

To represent or stand for something else, especially an idea or quality.

In kid words: When one thing stands for something bigger!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The multicolored alarm might symbolize the complexity of the villain's challenge."

symbolize freedom

symbolize hope

symbolize courage

✓ Means the SAME

represent

stand for

signify

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

literal

concrete

actual

✗ NOT examples

*saying exactly what you mean**a plain photograph**a simple label*

Why we use it

Understanding symbols helps you find hidden meanings in stories and poems!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

In this story, the _____ symbolizes...

connotation

noun

Word family: connotation connotations**● What it means**

An idea or feeling that a word suggests beyond its basic definition.

In kid words: The extra meaning or feeling that comes with a word!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The word 'home' has a warm connotation that 'house' does not."

positive connotation

negative connotation

connotation of home

✓ Means the SAME

implication

suggestion

association

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

denotation

literal meaning

definition

✗ NOT examples

a dictionary entry

a phone number

a math equation

**Why we use it**

Understanding connotation helps you choose the perfect words for your writing!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The connotation of the word _____ makes me think of...

implication

noun

Word family: **implication** **implications**

● What it means

A conclusion that can be drawn from something even though it is not directly stated.

In kid words: A hidden meaning that you figure out even though nobody said it directly!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The implication of his silence was that he disagreed with the decision."

an important implication

the implication of a statement

a hidden implication

✓ Means the SAME

suggestion

inference

hint

× Means the OPPOSITE

explicit statement

direct statement

clear declaration

× NOT examples

a loud announcement

a written instruction

saying it plainly



Why we use it

Understanding implications helps you read between the lines in stories and in life!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The implication of _____ is that...

denotation

noun

● What it means

The literal or primary meaning of a word, as found in a dictionary.

In kid words: The exact dictionary meaning of a word, without any extra feelings!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The denotation of the word blue is a color, but it can also suggest sadness."

the denotation of home

check the denotation

denotation versus connotation

✓ Means the SAME

definition

literal meaning

dictionary meaning

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

connotation

implication

suggestion

✗ NOT examples

*a feeling about a word**a hidden meaning**a personal opinion*

Why we use it

Knowing denotation helps you use words precisely and accurately!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The denotation of _____ is _____, but its connotation is...

suffix

noun

Word family: suffix suffixes prefix affix

● What it means

A letter or group of letters added to the end of a word to change its meaning or function.

In kid words: Letters you stick on the end of a word to make a new word!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Adding the suffix *-tion* to the word *'select'* creates *'selection.'*"

-tion -ment -able

✓ Means the SAME

ending word part affix

× Means the OPPOSITE

prefix root base word

× NOT examples

the first letter a whole word a sentence



Why we use it

Knowing suffixes helps you understand and build hundreds of new words!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

When I add the suffix _____ to the word _____, it becomes...

imagery

noun

Word family: **image** **images** **imagery** **imaginative**

● What it means

Visually descriptive language that appeals to the senses in writing.

In kid words: Words that paint pictures in your mind and make you see, hear, or feel things!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The poet used powerful imagery to describe the golden sunset melting into the ocean."

vivid imagery**visual imagery****sensory imagery**

✓ Means the SAME

description**word pictures****visualization**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

plain language**bare facts****abstract writing**

✗ NOT examples

a list of numbers***a blank page******a simple yes or no***

Why we use it

Imagery brings writing to life and makes readers feel like they are there!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The imagery in this poem made me picture...

simile

noun

Word family: simile similes similar similarity

● What it means

A figure of speech comparing two unlike things using 'like' or 'as.'

In kid words: When you say something IS LIKE something else to paint a picture!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The poet used the simile 'her smile was like sunshine' to show warmth."

brave as a lion

fast like the wind

cold as ice

✓ Means the SAME

comparison

analogy

likeness

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

literal statement

plain description

direct language

✗ NOT examples

*The sky is blue**I ate lunch**She ran fast*

Why we use it

Similes make your writing more vivid and interesting!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I can create a simile by comparing _____ to...

personification

noun

Word family: **personification** **personifications**

● What it means

Giving human qualities or abilities to non-human things or ideas.

In kid words: Making non-living things act like people in your writing!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"In the sentence 'The flowers danced in the breeze,' the writer used personification."

the wind whispered**time flies****the sun smiled**

✓ Means the SAME

humanization**anthropomorphism****figurative language**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

literal description**plain statement****factual language**

✗ NOT examples

a dog barked***she laughed******they walked home***

Why we use it

Personification makes your writing creative and fun to read!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I can use personification to describe _____ by saying...

proverb

noun

Word family: **proverb** **proverbs** **proverbial**

● What it means

A short, well-known saying that expresses a general truth or piece of advice.

In kid words: A famous short sentence that teaches a life lesson!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The proverb 'Actions speak louder than words' means what you do matters more than what you say."

a wise proverb**an ancient proverb****a common proverb**

✓ Means the SAME

saying

adage

maxim

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

fiction

falsehood

lie

✗ NOT examples

*a recipe**a math formula**a phone number*

Why we use it

Proverbs share wisdom from people all around the world!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**My favorite proverb is _____ because...**

idiom

noun

Word family: **idiom** **idioms** **idiomatic**

● What it means

A phrase whose meaning cannot be understood from the individual words alone.

In kid words: A saying that means something totally different from what the words say!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"When she said 'it is raining cats and dogs,' she used an idiom to mean it was raining very hard."

break a leg **piece of cake** **hit the books**

✓ Means the SAME

expression **saying****figure of speech**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

literal phrase **plain language****direct statement**

✗ NOT examples

I am hungry ***The cat sat down*** ***We went home***

? Why we use it

Knowing idioms helps you understand everyday English conversations!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**The idiom _____ really means...**

allusion

noun

Word family: allusion allusions allude alludes alluding
alluded

● What it means

A brief, indirect reference to a person, place, event, or work of literature.

In kid words: A quick mention of something famous that helps add meaning to your writing!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"When she called him 'a real Einstein,' she made an allusion to the famous scientist."

a biblical allusion a historical allusion a literary allusion

✓ Means the SAME

reference mention hint

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

direct statement
explicit explanation
full description

✗ NOT examples

a detailed biography a complete retelling a dictionary definition

? Why we use it

Recognizing allusions helps you understand deeper meanings in literature!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The allusion to _____ in the story means...

inference

noun

Word family: **infer** **infers** **inferring** **inferred** **inference**
inferences

● What it means

A conclusion reached by reasoning from evidence and clues rather than direct statements.

In kid words: A smart guess you make using clues from what you read!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Based on the dark clouds, we can make an inference that it will rain."

make an inference **a logical inference** **an inference from context**

✓ Means the SAME

conclusion **deduction**
judgment

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

guess **assumption** **wild guess**

✗ NOT examples

reading the answer directly **being told the answer**
seeing it written clearly



Why we use it

Making inferences helps you understand hidden meanings in stories and real life!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I made an inference that _____ because...

analogy

noun

Word family: analogy analogies analogous

● What it means

A comparison between two things to explain or clarify an idea.

In kid words: Showing how two different things are alike to help explain something!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The teacher used an analogy comparing the brain to a computer to explain memory."

draw an analogy

a helpful analogy

an analogy between

✓ Means the SAME

comparison

parallel

likeness

× Means the OPPOSITE

contrast

difference

dissimilarity

× NOT examples

a random fact

an unrelated topic

a contradiction



Why we use it

Analogies help you explain difficult ideas by connecting them to familiar things!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

An analogy for _____ would be...

context

noun

Word family: context contexts contextual contextualize

● What it means

The circumstances or setting that help determine the meaning of a word or event.

In kid words: The clues around a word or situation that help you understand it!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Using context clues, she figured out that the unfamiliar word meant happy."

context clues **historical context** **in context**

✓ Means the SAME

setting **background****circumstances**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

isolation **void** **vacuum**

✗ NOT examples

a random letter **a blank page** **a number without a problem**

Why we use it

Context is your best tool for figuring out unknown words!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The context of the sentence helped me understand that...

transformation

noun

Word family: transformation transformations

● What it means

A thorough or dramatic change in form, appearance, or character.

In kid words: A big change that makes something look or work completely differently!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The transformation of the caterpillar into a butterfly amazes scientists."

a butterfly transformation

a transformation of ideas

a dramatic transformation

✓ Means the SAME

change

conversion

metamorphosis

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

preservation

stagnation

sameness

✗ NOT examples

staying the same

a small scratch

no change at all



Why we use it

Understanding transformations helps you see how things change and grow!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**The biggest transformation I have seen is when...**

linguistic

adjective

Word family: **linguistic** **linguistically**

● What it means

Relating to language or the study of languages.

In kid words: Having to do with words, languages, and how people communicate!

● Teacher models (I Do)

*"Her linguistic abilities allowed her to translate between four different languages."***linguistic skills****a linguistic pattern****linguistic diversity**

✓ Means the SAME

verbal

language-related

communicative

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

nonverbal

silent

unspoken

✗ NOT examples

*a math problem**a chemical reaction**a painting*

Why we use it

Understanding linguistic concepts helps you become a stronger communicator!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**A linguistic pattern I noticed is...**

morpheme

noun

Word family: morpheme morphemes morphology

● What it means

The smallest unit of meaning in a language, such as a prefix, root, or suffix.

In kid words: The tiniest piece of a word that still has its own meaning!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The word 'unhappily' contains three morphemes: un-, happy, and -ly."

un- is a morpheme

play is a morpheme

-ed is a morpheme

✓ Means the SAME

word part

unit

element

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

sentence

paragraph

full text

✗ NOT examples

*a random letter**a punctuation mark**a space between words*

Why we use it

Knowing morphemes helps you decode even the longest, hardest words!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I can break the word _____ into morphemes like...

synthesis

noun

Word family: **synthesis** **syntheses** **synthesize** **synthesizing**
synthesized **synthetic**

● What it means

The combining of different ideas, elements, or things into a connected whole.

In kid words: Mixing different ideas together to create something new and complete!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Her essay was a brilliant synthesis of science, history, and personal experience."

a synthesis of ideas **creative synthesis** **a synthesis of research**

✓ Means the SAME

combination**blend****integration**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

analysis**separation****breakdown**

✗ NOT examples

taking things apart**keeping ideas separate****ignoring connections**

Why we use it

Synthesis shows you can connect ideas from different sources into something original!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I created a synthesis of _____ and _____ by...

milestone

noun

Word family: milestone milestones**● What it means**

An important event or achievement that marks a significant stage in development.

In kid words: A big moment that shows how far you have come!**● Teacher models (I Do)**

"Learning to read in a second language is an important milestone for every student."

a major milestone

reach a milestone

a personal milestone

✓ Means the SAME

achievement

landmark

breakthrough

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

setback

failure

regression

✗ NOT examples

an ordinary day

eating breakfast

tying your shoes

**Why we use it**

Celebrating milestones motivates you to keep achieving more!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**A milestone in my learning was when I...**

determination

noun

Word family: determination determinations**● What it means**

The quality of being firmly committed to a purpose; strong will.

In kid words: The strong feeling inside that keeps you going no matter what!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Her determination to learn English helped her succeed in her new school."

show determination

with great determination

fierce determination

✓ Means the SAME

resolve

persistence

grit

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

indecision

hesitation

surrender

✗ NOT examples

giving up easily

quitting halfway

being lazy

**Why we use it**

Determination is the secret ingredient to achieving any goal!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**I showed determination when I...**

proficient

adjective

Word family: **proficient** **proficiently**

● What it means

Competent or skilled in doing or using something.

In kid words: Really good at doing something because you practiced a lot!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"After rehearsing for two months, the orchestra members became proficient performers."

She is proficient in three languages.

The musician became proficient after years of practice.

He is proficient at solving math problems.

✓ Means the SAME

skilled**competent****capable**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

incompetent**unskilled****inexperienced**

✗ NOT examples

someone just starting to learn***a beginner who makes many mistakes******someone who has never tried***

? Why we use it

Proficient is a great academic word for describing someone who is skilled. You will see it on report cards and in school evaluations!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I am proficient at ___ because I ___.

demonstrate

verb

Word family: demonstrate demonstrates demonstrating
demonstrated demonstrator demonstration demonstrative

● What it means

To show clearly by giving proof or evidence; to display a skill or quality.

In kid words: To show or prove something so others can see it!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The runners demonstrated their determination by finishing the race despite the terrible weather."

The runners demonstrated incredible endurance.

She demonstrated her knowledge on the science exam.

The experiment demonstrated how gravity works.

✓ Means the SAME

show prove exhibit

× Means the OPPOSITE

conceal hide disguise

× NOT examples

keeping a skill secret hiding your abilities refusing to show your work



Why we use it

Demonstrate is a key academic word used across all subjects. Teachers often ask you to demonstrate understanding!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I demonstrated ___ when I ___.

eloquent

adjective

Word family: eloquent eloquently

● What it means

Fluent or persuasive in speaking or writing; clearly expressing feelings or ideas.

In kid words: Using beautiful, clear words that make people listen!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The coach gave an eloquent speech that motivated every player before the big game."

The speaker gave an eloquent speech about courage.

Her eloquent writing moved the audience to tears.

He is an eloquent debater who wins every argument.

✓ Means the SAME

articulate

expressive

fluent

× Means the OPPOSITE

inarticulate

tongue-tied

mumbling

× NOT examples

*speaking in a confusing way**mumbling so no one understands**using the wrong words repeatedly*

Why we use it

Eloquent describes powerful communication. When you can express ideas clearly and beautifully, people will listen!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The most eloquent thing I have heard was ____.

synthesize

verb

Word family: **synthesize** **synthesizes** **synthesizing** **synthesized**
synthesizer

● What it means

To combine different ideas, influences, or elements into a connected whole.

In kid words: To put different ideas together to make something new!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Great thinkers synthesize knowledge from many fields to create new ideas."

Scientists synthesize data from many experiments.

The student synthesized ideas from three different sources.

Artists synthesize colors and shapes to create masterpieces.

✓ Means the SAME

combine **integrate** **merge**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

separate **divide** **analyze**

✗ NOT examples

copying one source exactly **only looking at one idea**

keeping ideas completely separate

? Why we use it

Synthesize is a top-level thinking word. When you synthesize, you create something new from different pieces -- that is the highest form of learning!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I can synthesize ___ and ___ to ___.

evaluate

verb

Word family: **evaluate** **evaluates** **evaluating** **evaluated** **evaluation**
reevaluate

● What it means

To judge or determine the significance, worth, or quality of something.

In kid words: To look carefully at something and decide how good it is!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"After reading the story, the class evaluated the author's use of figurative language."

Teachers evaluate student work using rubrics.

Scientists evaluate their results carefully.

We need to evaluate the plan before we begin.

✓ Means the SAME

assess **judge** **appraise**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

ignore **overlook** **disregard**

✗ NOT examples

guessing without looking at evidence

accepting everything without thinking

skipping the review process

? Why we use it

Evaluate is one of the most important academic words. Every time you think critically about quality, you are evaluating!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I evaluated ___ by looking at ___.

transform

verb

Word family: **transform** **transforms** **transforming** **transformed**
transformer **transformation**

● What it means

To change in form, appearance, nature, or character in a significant way.

In kid words: To change something completely into something new or different!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Traveling to different countries transformed the writer's understanding of the world."

Travel can transform the way you see the world.

The caterpillar transformed into a butterfly.

Education transforms lives every single day.

✓ Means the SAME

change **convert** **alter**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

preserve **maintain** **keep**

✗ NOT examples

leaving something exactly the same

making a tiny unnoticeable change

keeping the original form

? Why we use it

Transform is a powerful word for describing big changes. It comes from the Latin roots trans- (across) and form (shape)!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

Traveling to ___ transformed my understanding of ___.

recognition

noun

Word family: **recognition** **recognitions**

● What it means

Acknowledgment of achievement or identification of something previously encountered.

In kid words: When people notice and appreciate what you have done!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The student received recognition for her outstanding science project."

receive recognition**earn recognition****in recognition of**

✓ Means the SAME

acknowledgment**appreciation****honor**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

neglect**ignorance****dismissal**

✗ NOT examples

being ignored***no one noticing******forgetting someone***

Why we use it

Recognition motivates us to keep doing our best work!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**I felt recognition when...**

aspire

verb

Word family: **aspire** **aspires** **aspiring** **aspired** **aspiration**

● What it means

To direct one's hopes or ambitions toward achieving something great.

In kid words: To dream big and want to reach an amazing goal!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The poet aspired to inspire readers to take the road less traveled."

She aspires to become a doctor.

Many young athletes aspire to compete in the Olympics.

He aspires to write novels that change the world.

✓ Means the SAME

dream **aim** **strive**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

settle **resign** **despair**

✗ NOT examples

not caring about the future **avoiding challenges** **having no goals at all**



Why we use it

Aspire comes from the Latin aspirare, meaning 'to breathe toward.' When you aspire, you are reaching for something wonderful!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I aspire to ___ because ___.

dialect

noun

Word family: **dialect** **dialects****● What it means**

A particular form of a language that is specific to a region or social group.

In kid words: A special way of speaking that people in one area or group use!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Different regions of the country have their own dialects with unique words and sounds."

a regional dialect**a southern dialect****a local dialect****✓ Means the SAME**

variety

vernacular

accent

× Means the OPPOSITE

standard language

formal speech

universal language

× NOT examples*a foreign language**sign language**computer code***Why we use it**

Learning about dialects helps you appreciate how rich and diverse language is!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**A dialect I have heard is _____ and it sounds like...**

expressive

adjective

Word family: expressive expressively expressiveness

● What it means

Effectively showing or communicating thoughts and feelings.

In kid words: Showing what you think and feel through words, art, or actions!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The poet's expressive language made readers feel the joy and sadness in every line."

an expressive face

expressive writing

an expressive performance

✓ Means the SAME

communicative

demonstrative

revealing

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

blank

reserved

unexpressive

✗ NOT examples

a stone face

silence

an empty page



Why we use it

Being expressive helps you connect with others through your words and actions!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The most expressive part of the poem was...

versatile

adjective

Word family: versatile versatility

● What it means

Able to adapt or be adapted to many different functions or activities.

In kid words: Being good at lots of different things, not just one!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"She is a versatile student who excels in both science and creative writing."

a versatile athlete

a versatile tool

a versatile writer

✓ Means the SAME

adaptable

flexible

multitalented

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

limited

rigid

inflexible

✗ NOT examples

*a one-trick pony**a single-use item**doing only one thing*

? Why we use it

Being versatile means you can succeed in many different situations!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I am versatile because I can...

diligent

adjective

Word family: diligent diligently

● What it means

Having or showing care and effort in one's work or duties.

In kid words: Working really hard and carefully on everything you do!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The diligent researcher checked every source before writing her report."

a diligent student

diligent practice

diligent research

✓ Means the SAME

hardworking

industrious

conscientious

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

lazy

careless

negligent

✗ NOT examples

sleeping in class

skipping homework

rushing through work



Why we use it

Being diligent leads to excellent results and makes people trust your work!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I am diligent when I...

adept

adjective

Word family: **adept** **adeptly**● **What it means**

Very skilled or proficient at something.

In kid words: Being really, really good at something because of lots of practice!

● **Teacher models (I Do)**

"After months of practice, she became adept at identifying parts of speech in any sentence."

an adept reader**adept at solving problems****an adept musician**✓ **Means the SAME****skilled****proficient****expert**✗ **Means the OPPOSITE****clumsy****unskilled****incompetent**✗ **NOT examples*****a first attempt******falling down******guessing wildly*****Why we use it**

Becoming adept at grammar makes all your reading and writing easier!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**I am becoming adept at...**

embody

verb

Word family: **embody** **embodies** **embodying** **embodied**
embodiment

● What it means

To give a body or form to an idea; to represent or express something in a visible way.

In kid words: Being a perfect example of something or showing it through your actions!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The volunteer program embodies the school's commitment to community service."

embody courage **embody kindness** **embody the spirit**

✓ Means the SAME

represent **exemplify** **personify**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

contradict **misrepresent** **hide**

✗ NOT examples

talking without acting *an empty promise*

saying one thing and doing another



Why we use it

When you embody a quality, you become a living example for others!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I try to embody _____ by...

vivid**adjective****Word family:** vivid vividly● **What it means**

Producing powerful feelings or strong, clear images in the mind.

In kid words: So clear and colorful that you can almost see, hear, or feel it!

● **Teacher models (I Do)**

"The author used vivid language to describe the sunset over the ocean."

a vivid description**vivid colors****a vivid memory**✓ **Means the SAME****striking****graphic****brilliant**✗ **Means the OPPOSITE****dull****vague****faint**✗ **NOT examples****a blank page****gray walls****a foggy window****Why we use it**

Vivid writing makes readers feel like they are inside your story!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The most vivid part of the story was when...

nuance

noun

Word family: nuance nuances nuanced

● What it means

A subtle difference in or shade of meaning, expression, or sound.

In kid words: A tiny but important difference that changes the meaning of something!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Understanding the nuance between 'happy' and 'elated' makes your writing more precise."

a subtle nuance

nuances of language

nuance in writing

✓ Means the SAME

subtlety

shade

distinction

× Means the OPPOSITE

obvious difference

bluntness

simplicity

× NOT examples

black and white

a loud shout

an obvious answer



Why we use it

Noticing nuances shows you are becoming a sophisticated reader and writer!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The nuance between _____ and _____ is...

compose

verb

Word family: **compose** **composes** **composing** **composed****composer** **composition** **decompose**

● What it means

To write or create something, especially a piece of writing or music.

In kid words: Putting words or notes together to create something new and beautiful!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The students learned to compose persuasive essays using evidence and strong arguments."

compose an essay**compose a song****compose a letter**

✓ Means the SAME

write**create****craft**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

destroy**erase****dismantle**

✗ NOT examples

copying someone else**leaving a page blank****tearing up paper**

Why we use it

Composing is how you turn your ideas into something others can read and enjoy!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**When I compose a piece of writing, I start by...**

integrate

verb

Word family: **integrate** **integrates** **integrating** **integrated**
integration **disintegrate**

● What it means

To combine or bring together different parts into a unified whole.

In kid words: Putting different pieces together to make something complete!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The teacher helped us integrate science and writing into one project."

integrate ideas **integrate subjects** **integrate technology**

✓ Means the SAME

combine **merge** **unify**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

separate **divide** **isolate**

✗ NOT examples

breaking apart **scattering pieces** **keeping things separate**



Why we use it

Integrating knowledge from different areas makes your learning stronger!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

We can integrate _____ and _____ by...

consolidate

verb

Word family: **consolidate** **consolidates** **consolidating** **consolidated**
consolidation

● What it means

To combine separate items into a single, stronger whole; to strengthen.

In kid words: Bringing things together to make them stronger or simpler!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Before the test, she consolidated all her notes into one study guide."

consolidate notes**consolidate ideas****consolidate skills**

✓ Means the SAME

combine**strengthen****unify**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

scatter**weaken****divide**

✗ NOT examples

losing papers**forgetting lessons****starting over**

Why we use it

Consolidating what you know helps you remember it better!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I consolidate my learning by...

criterion

noun

Word family: **criterion** **criteria**

● What it means

A standard or principle by which something may be judged or decided.

In kid words: A rule or measure you use to decide if something is good enough!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"One criterion for a good essay is that it has a clear thesis statement."

meet the criterion**an important criterion****evaluation criterion**

✓ Means the SAME

standard**measure****benchmark**

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

guess**random choice****whim**

✗ NOT examples

flipping a coin**picking randomly****no rules at all**

Why we use it

Having clear criteria helps you judge quality and improve your own work!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The most important criterion for _____ is...

culmination

noun

● What it means

The highest or final point of something; the climax.

In kid words: The big, exciting ending or the most important moment of something!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The science fair was the culmination of months of research and hard work."

the culmination of efforts

a grand culmination

the culmination of a journey

✓ Means the SAME

climax

peak

conclusion

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

beginning

start

introduction

✗ NOT examples

the first day of school

a rough draft

waking up in the morning



Why we use it

Reaching a culmination means you have accomplished something great!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

The culmination of our project was when...

legacy

noun

Word family: **legacy** **legacies**

● What it means

Something handed down from the past; a lasting impact or contribution.

In kid words: The important things you leave behind for others to remember and use!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"The great teacher left a legacy of students who love learning."

a lasting legacy**a family legacy****a legacy of kindness**

✓ Means the SAME

heritage

inheritance

contribution

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

forgetfulness

insignificance

obscurity

✗ NOT examples

*something temporary**a disposable item**a passing moment*

Why we use it

Thinking about your legacy inspires you to make a positive difference!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)**The legacy I want to leave is...**

flourish

verb

Word family: flourish flourishes flourishing flourished

● What it means

To grow or develop in a healthy, vigorous way; to thrive.

In kid words: Growing strong and doing really well, like a plant in sunshine!

● Teacher models (I Do)

"Students flourish when they have supportive teachers and engaging lessons."

students flourish

ideas flourish

cultures flourish

✓ Means the SAME

thrive

prosper

bloom

✗ Means the OPPOSITE

wither

decline

struggle

✗ NOT examples

a dying plant

an empty classroom

giving up



Why we use it

Everyone can flourish when they have the right support and keep trying!

Your turn (We Do → You Do)

I flourish when...